

10 Firefox Despite the new and shiny Google Chrome browser, Firefox remains one of the greatest browsers ever. While the browser has lagged behind Chrome and Opera of late, it has an enthusiastic new v4 coming that should restore its former glory.



7 Calibre If you love eBooks, Calibre is the best application to manage them for you. This brilliant application created by an India developer supports a number of unique features. Besides managing your eBook library, it can convert eBooks, sync to eBook reader devices, download news feeds and convert them to eBooks, and even set up a server to access your collection remotely.



9 Dropbox Dropbox is a great file synchronization application that works across platforms. It contends well with inconsistencies between the different platform, and manages to Just Work without requiring too much user input. It offers free storage up to 2GB and offers paid upgrades to storage as well.



6 VLC Nothing makes multimedia simple for Linux users than VLC. With this single application installed, you can play back nearly any multimedia format available. VLC has an extensive feature set, from playing YouTube videos to encoding and saving streaming files to an inbuilt media library.

4 Gnome-Do / Krunker ScreenToaster is a free web based screen capture tool. Registration is not compulsory. All you need to do is visit the site and click Record. This one is a clear cut replacement of desktop applications such as CamStudio. The only trouble is the app suffers a lot of downtime.



3 GIMP The GNU Image Manipulation Program; nearly everyone has heard of this brilliant image editing application that does its best against image editors such as Photoshop. While it isn't the simplest application to use, it more than makes up for it with its extensive features and scripting support. Recently it has taken heed of critics and is working towards a more Photoshop-like interface



tions, and matches in feature to even many commercial applications such as Adobe Photoshop / Lightroom. With features such as image fingerprinting, plug-in support, and exporting/ importing files on photo sharing services, and brilliant tagging, searching and editing support it is the best application of its kind.



8 Blender Blender is a popular professional 3D editor for all platforms. It is capable of producing high quality rendered content, and has been used to make films such as Elephants Dream, Big Buck Bunny, and Sintel. It even includes advanced video compositing and editing features and can be used to create games.



5 LibreOffice With OpenOffice.org in Oracle's hands, the community has now forked out with LibreOffice as the new office suite of choice for Linux. It builds on OpenOffice.org and already surpasses it with the inclusion of many community developed features and extensions. Keep a lookout for LibreOffice as most of the active OpenOffice developers are now part of LibreOffice.

2 digiKam If you've used KDE, you've probably heard of digiKam. It is possibly one of the best image management applications,



Wine

Windows remains till date, the most popular operating system, which ensures that more applications are developed for it than for other OSes, which ensures that it is the most popular operating system.

Wine attempts to break out of this chicken and egg cycle by making Linux capable of running Windows applications. Using Wine, Linux users can run even complicated applications such as Photoshop and Microsoft Office, and can play Windows games such as Half Life 2, and Starcraft II. Wine has seen significant improvements in compatibility and stability recently, and continues to be very actively developed.

Wine ensures that those coming to the world of Windows don't have to leave their favourite applications behind, giving them yet another reason to shift to a the free operating system. For these reasons and many others it is the best software for the Linux platform.

